The balance of power, however, had changed irrevocably between Akbar and his ‘Khan Baba’ and the Padshah made it clear that Bairam Khan was to arrange his affairs and proceed to Mecca.[†] Bairam Khan left with a small retinue including his wives, his son, and Shaikh Gadai. As he did not head for Mecca immediately, his actions were interpreted as rebellious and Akbar sent Maulana Pir Mohammad Shirwani to pursue him. Humiliated and exasperated, Bairam Khan moved deeper into the Punjab. Akbar was disconcerted enough by the actions of Bairam Khan to send an army to confront him. There were even worrying rumours that Bairam Khan was planning to declare Kamran’s son, Mirza Abu’l Qasim, Padshah in place of Akbar. While the army set off under Ataka Khan, Akbar himself made preparations to follow his troops into the Punjab. Bairam Khan’s followers were routed by the imperial forces at Sultanpur, and the disgraced khankhanan finally sought refuge with the Hindu ruler Raja Ganesh of Talwara. Munim Khan, making his way south from Kabul, met with Akbar and his retinue at Machhiwara and then they all continued on to Sirhind.

At Sirhind, Munim Khan was given the title khankhanan and was appointed wakil. His new responsibilities would include control over financial as well as military and administrative affairs, as had been the case with Bairam Khan, and Akbar would also show him the same deference he had shown Bairam Khan, always addressing him as Khan Baba. At Talwara, meanwhile, Bairam Khan had taken stock of all that he had lost, and contemplated with sorrow his utter disgrace. He asked for Munim Khan to be sent to accept his surrender saying:

> I have taken refuge with the infidels urged by necessity. If you come and, seizing my hands take me out of the hills, I shall go with you.

He was then presented, weeping and debased, before Akbar who embraced his Khan Baba and made him sit on the takht beside him one last time and spoke to him kindly, with all his old affection. Akbar dismissed Bairam Khan with honour, bestowing a special robe on him and giving him 50,000 rupees in cash for his maintenance but this would be the last time that Akbar would meet his ataliq and Bairam Khan left the court, heading for Mecca, his dreams evaporated and exiled from the empire he had helped create.